AAAJ SLR Writing Template v2

EXP training artifact: journal article PDF -> paragraph-level writing template

How To Use This Template

- Use after the deep reading gate has passed. Do not begin Word drafting from a shallow skim.
- This is a structure template, not a content template. It copies rhetorical moves, not source wording.
- For each paragraph, fill the drafting space with the new topic, then verify the quality check.
- For AI agents: retrieve this EXP, read the source-to-template logic, then draft section by section instead of producing a generic article outline.

Deep Reading Gate Before Writing

Gate item	Required evidence	Pass condition
Article thesis	One sentence stating what the source article is trying to accomplish structurally.	The thesis explains the article architecture, not only its topic.
Section function map	Each major section has a named rhetorical job.	No section is described only by its heading.
Paragraph role map	Each introduction, method, synthesis, and discussion paragraph has a functional role.	The map can guide a fresh draft paragraph-by-paragraph.
Evidence apparatus	Tables, figures, appendix, and references are assigned functions.	Every non-text object has a reason for existing.
Non-copying check	Reusable moves are separated from original article language.	No long source sentences are reused.

Article Logic

field emergence -> conceptual contrast -> review warrant -> theoretical antecedents -> systematic review design -> exploratory/descriptive mapping -> narrative synthesis by phases -> research agenda -> conceptual warning

Title Formula

Unpacking [concept/field]: a systematic literature review and research agenda

Use when the article opens up a field, organises past work, and builds a future agenda.

Structured Abstract

Build the compressed map of the review: aim, corpus/method, layered findings, and contribution.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
Purpose	Name the field, state the review aim, specify what developments/themes are examined, and signal the agenda.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
Design/methodology/approach	State SLR approach, corpus size, databases/search sources, date range, and source boundary.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
Findings	Report three outputs: classification/content analysis, descriptive or bibliometric mapping, and	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

	narrative/conceptual synthesis.		
Originality/value	Explain what the review synthesises and what new agenda, conceptual framing, or field warning it creates.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
Keywords / Paper type	Use field, method, and concept terms that make the paper searchable and position it as a literature review.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

1. Introduction

Move from field emergence to review warrant, review questions, purposes, and roadmap.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
P1 Field emergence	Open with the reviewed field as recent, productive, and significant. Make the reader feel a review is timely.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P2 Practice/concept rationale	Connect the field to a concrete stakeholder, participation, governance, or disciplinary problem.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P3 Representative approaches	Give compact examples of methods, settings, or tools without turning the introduction into the full review.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P4 Main contrast	Clarify the concept by contrasting it with a dominant opposing model or older assumption.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P5 Positive definition	State what the reviewed concept enables, changes, or opens up for research and practice.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P6 Review questions	Turn the field problem into broad review questions: what has been done, how, and what remains possible.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P7 Review purposes	State two or three purposes and link each purpose to a later analytical step.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P8 Roadmap	Preview the article sequence from theory/background to method, analyses, synthesis, and agenda.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

2. Antecedents / Theoretical Background

Show that the reviewed field has intellectual roots before the paper starts counting or classifying studies.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
P1 Intellectual ancestry	Name the theories or traditions that inspired the field and explain why they matter.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P2 Foundational tradition 1	Summarise the first root, then connect its core idea to	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific;	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to

	the review topic.	do not copy source article wording.]	previous/next paragraph clear?
P3 Foundational tradition 2	Show how a second tradition adds another dimension or tension.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P4 Political/social theory foundation	Use theory to explain why the field contains debate, pluralism, or normative stakes.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P5 Synthesis/transition	Close the background by explaining why these roots justify the review design.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

3. Review Design and Exploratory Analyses

Make the review replicable, then use descriptive and network evidence to map the field before the narrative synthesis.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
P1 Method overview	Explain why the SLR defines the field boundary and why complementary analyses are useful.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P2 SLR rationale	Justify literature review as the right method for mapping an emerging or dispersed field.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P3 Search strategy	Name databases, search tools, search strings, and core terms clearly enough to replicate.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P4 Inclusion criteria	List language, source type, domain, topic, and quality/source boundaries explicitly.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P5 Screening and corpus	Show how raw results become the final corpus through deduplication and manual screening.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P6 Publication trend	Use a figure to show growth over time and interpret what the trend says about the field.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P7 Outlet/source profile	Describe journals, books, disciplines, or source clusters to locate the literature.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P8 Content analysis rationale	Explain why each contribution is coded into comparable categories.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P9 Coding scheme	Define categories such as method, geography, sector, theory, findings, and future research.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P10 Descriptive classification	Use tables to compress what kinds of studies exist and where gaps appear.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P11 Bibliometric rationale	Explain why network or citation analysis helps interpret a large corpus.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

P12 Coupling/co-citation logic	Define the network method before presenting any visual map.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P13 Keyword/coauthor/journal maps	Link every map to a specific interpretive function, not decoration.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

4. Narrative Review and Discussion of Contributions

Convert mapped literature into a developmental story organized by phases, clusters, or contribution types.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
P1 Narrative rationale	Explain why selected influential works now need deeper discussion.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P2 Chronological/phase roadmap	Tell readers how the narrative is organised across phases or clusters.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P3 Phase 1 opening	Name the period, works, and contribution of the first phase.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P4 Phase 1 evidence	Cluster representative works by shared intellectual move.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P5 Phase 1 transition	Summarise why the phase matters and hand to the next phase.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P6 Phase 2 opening	State how the field changes, matures, or consolidates.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P7 Phase 2 evidence	Use works to show debates, applications, and core concepts.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P8 Phase 2 transition	Identify tensions and emerging directions.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P9 Phase 3 opening	Mark expansion into new topics, contexts, methods, or technologies.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P10 Phase 3 evidence	Group newer works as expansion rather than disconnected examples.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P11 Phase 4/method opening	Introduce methodological diversification or unusual empirical designs.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P12 Phase 4 evidence	Explain why the new methods matter for future development of the field.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

5. Discussion and Conclusions

Return from detailed synthesis to field-level contribution, agenda, limits, and conceptual warning.

Unit	Writing move	Drafting space	Quality check
P1 Aim restatement	Remind readers what the review set out to do and what evidence base it used.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P2 Field trajectory synthesis	Turn many studies into a concise developmental story.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P3 Agenda direction 1	Convert observed trends into future research questions about methods, tools, or technologies.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P4 Agenda direction 2	Convert gaps into future questions about context, institutions, actors, or settings.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?
P5 Conceptual warning	End with a boundary condition: what the concept must not become or be reduced to.	[Write the paragraph here. Keep content topic-specific; do not copy source article wording.]	Does this paragraph perform only this move? Is its link to previous/next paragraph clear?

Tables, Figures, and Appendix Functions

Object type	Typical placement	Function	Do not use it for
Search flow figure/table	Review design	Transparency: show how corpus was built.	Decorating the method section.
Publication trend figure	Exploratory analysis	Demonstrate field growth and timing.	Claiming contribution without interpretation.
Classification tables	Exploratory analysis	Compress method, geography, sector, theory, and topic distributions.	Replacing narrative synthesis.
Network maps	Exploratory analysis	Reveal intellectual or topical clusters.	Visual complexity without a reading.
Phase table	Narrative review	Summarise developmental phases and representative works.	Dumping all reviewed papers.
Research agenda table	Discussion	Turn gaps into researchable questions.	A generic future research list.
Appendix corpus/search details	End matter	Keep transparency without overloading main text.	Hiding essential method decisions.

AI Agent Prompt Pack

Deep read prompt: Read the source journal article as a structure model. Produce a paragraph role map that names what each paragraph does, not what it says.

Template drafting prompt: Using the paragraph role map, create a writing template for a new SLR article. Preserve rhetorical moves, section order, and evidence functions; do not copy source wording.

Section drafting prompt: Draft only Section [X] for topic [Y]. Follow the paragraph role sequence exactly and mark missing evidence instead of inventing it.

Quality review prompt: Check whether each paragraph performs its assigned move, whether transitions work, and whether tables/figures are doing analytical work.

Final Quality Checklist

- The introduction contains emergence, rationale, contrast, questions, purposes, and roadmap.
- The theory/background section explains roots before method starts.
- The review design is replicable and has explicit inclusion/exclusion logic.
- Descriptive tables and figures are interpreted, not merely inserted.
- Narrative synthesis converts studies into a developmental story.
- Discussion converts findings into agenda and conceptual warning.
- The template uses no long copied source wording.
- A human can follow it as a writing plan and an AI agent can follow it as an execution plan.

Do Not

- Do not use the source article topic as the new article content unless explicitly asked.
- Do not collapse the template into generic Introduction/Methods/Findings headings.
- Do not copy source paragraphs, sentences, tables, or figures.
- Do not start Word formatting until the deep reading gate has produced a usable role map.